

RestoreIT! 3 Deluxe

Crash-proof your PC in one step

RestoreIT! 3 is quite simple to install. The wizard asks you which drive to include in the static restore point and asks for the partition that needs to be split. This new partition is used to back up the selected drive(s). On our test PC, it reduced the primary partition by 10 per cent and created a new RestoreIT! partition of 4 GB.

If your OS crashes and you are unable to boot, you would still be able to restore your entire backup since RestoreIT has a built-in operating system of its own that is the first to get control of your system. Apart from the backup and restore options, you can even lock, unlock, rename, and delete a restore point. There's also an Option command in the View menu that shows you the properties of the RestoreIT! partition by default.

The Schedule tab allows you to set up restore points automatically, which can be created during startup or while

the system is running. You can even disable automatic creation of restore points.

The setup lets you change your password, as well as select authorisation at system startup. Unlike the BIOS password which can be cleared by a CMOS reset, this one is permanent.

We tested it on a newly-installed Windows XP machine without installing the soundcard drivers, Ethernet card and display controller. Then we installed the wrong drivers, crashed the system and restored it using RestoreIT! 3—the system was restored successfully. RestoreIT! 3 is a reliable, user-friendly and easy to use program at a great price.

SPECIFICATIONS

Package contents: Software CD and a user's guide
System Requirements: 133 MHz CPU, 32 MB RAM, Windows 9x/Me/NT/2000/XP, FAT16/FAT32/NTFS file system, 15 MB hard disk space and 10 per cent hard disk drive space for backup files

RestoreIT! 3 Deluxe		B+
Performance	►►►►►	
Ease of use	►►►►►	
Value for money	►►►►►	
Features	►►►►►	
OVERALL	►►►►►	

Price: Rs 2,750
Contact: B. M. Technologies
Phone: 022-28728921
Fax: 022-28729028
E-mail: bmtch@vsnl.com
Web site: www.farstone.com

IBM Microdrive 1GB

A small drive from Big Blue

The latest Microdrive from IBM is a 1 GB drive that you can easily slip into your wallet. The package includes a PCMCIA converter, a detailed manual and a driver floppy for Windows 9x. The drive measures a mere 36x42x5 mm and uses GMR (Giant MagnetoResistive) heads for reading and writing data on to the disk. The primary advantage of GMR heads is their greater sen-



sitivity to magnetic fields emanating from the disk. This increased sensitivity makes it possible to detect smaller recorded bits and to read these bits at considerably higher

data rates. Also, large signals from GMR heads overcome the electronic noise, thus reducing errors in data accessing.

The drive requires the newer CompactFlash+ slot standard. It connects to a laptop using the bundled PCMCIA converter but a desktop PC will need a USB card.

The drive took 6 minutes to read 650 MB of data and 12 minutes to write the same. In the SiSoft Sandra test, the drive logged a drive index score of 1312, which is slightly low for a removable drive at 3600 rpm.

Price: Rs 18,000
Contact: Spectra Innovations Inc
Phone: 080-5092149
Fax: 080-5092148
Web site: www.ibm.com

In other tests, the drive logged a very high CPU utilisation—around 94.8 per cent.

The IBM Microdrive provides excellent storage space in a very small form factor. With a price tag of Rs 18,000, the drive is surely on the expensive side, but still is cheaper compared to a Flash memory stick.

SPECIFICATIONS

1 GB capacity, CF+ Type II interface, 128 KB segmented buffer, integrated controller, 3,600-rpm rotational speed

IBM Microdrive 1GB		B
Performance	►►►►►	
Build quality	►►►►►	
Value for money	►►►►►	
Features	►►►►►	
OVERALL	►►►►►	

ACi Ethos 4 Laptop

In the lap of Ethos

Ethos is based on an Intel Pentium 4 1.7 GHz Mobile Processor, has 256 MB of DDR RAM and 13 different ports. It has a COM port, an LPT Port, two USB ports, a FireWire Port, an infrared port, two ports for sound in/out, a volume control knob, an external VGA port, an RJ11 (telephone line) connector, an Ethernet port, a PS port for Video Out and a PS/2 port for the mouse or keyboard. Apart from these, a PCMCIA socket is available to add extra devices. It also has a Kensington lock for security.

To test its performance, we used Battery Mark 4.01, Content Creation 2001, Business Winstone 2001, SiSoft Sandra Pro and Quake III Arena. On the performance front, its scores are pretty well rounded.

The touch pad is smooth and sensitive to mouse movements. However, clicking is



less responsive. The package holds a notebook, a power adapter and a driver CD within a laptop bag. Any kind of documentation was absent.

After considering its performance, features, value and the current competitive market, ACi's Ethos 4 scores only an average mark.

SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium 4 1.7 GHz Mobile Processor, 256 MB DDR RAM, 40 GB hard disk, 14.1-inch TFT screen, SiS 650 display card, 1.44 MB floppy drive, 24x QSI CD-ROM drive, Realtek RTL8139 Ethernet adapter, Smart Link 56K voice modem

Price: Rs 76,990
Contact: Allied Computer International (Asia) Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-26733120/4
Fax: 022-26733119
E-mail: sales@aci-asia.com
Web site: www.aci-asia.com

ACi Ethos 4 Laptop		B-
Performance	►►►►►	
Build Quality	►►►►►	
Value for money	►►►►►	
Features	►►►►►	
OVERALL	►►►►►	